WATER WORLD



Karnataka deputy CM **D.K. Shivakumar** showed another side of him recently, with a 314-page monograph on water management. 'Neerina Hejje (Footprint of Water)' traces the course of water disputes in Karnataka. DKS says the insights came from his time heading the water resources ministry. Effusive praise came from CM **Siddaramaiah** who released the book. The CM also had the audience in splits, wondering aloud how DKS "found the time to accomplish the feat".

Rumour has it...



Tamil Nadu politics is abuzz with another rumour, this time about a possible alliance between actor **Vijay's** Thamizhaga Vetri Kazhagam (TVK) and the **Congress**. The speculation began after Rahul Gandhi called Vijay following the Karur tragedy and gathered extra steam when a few Congress leaders hinted at "different alliances" if they aren't happy with the seats. DMK leaders, however, see this as nothing more than the usual pre-seat-sharing theatrics.

SENIOR VS SENIOR?



With cabinet reshuffles all the rage in BJP-ruled states, all eyes are on Madhya Pradesh where too a rejig is due. A large number of senior MLAs who were ministers in the previous Shivraj Chouhan regime are waiting in the wings to get inducted. Sources in CM **Mohan Yadav's** camp had claimed the reshuffle would happen post the Bihar election so that his detractors would get a clear message who is in charge. The problem is that his opponents in the cabinet are also mostly from the old guard. So, will they now be pitted against the seniors waiting outside?

Kaushik Deka with Avaneesh Mishra, Ajay Sukumaran, Kavitha Muralidharan and Rahul Noronha

HEALTH WATCH

DIABETES CHALLENGE
HIDDEN COST OF HIGH SUGAR

By **Sonali Acharjee**

As the world marked World Diabetes Day on November 14, India's RSSDI Clinical Practice Guidelines 2025 were sounding an urgent alarm—not just about blood sugar, but about household budgets. Released at the end of October, the new consensus from the Research Society for the Study of Diabetes in India (RSSDI) reveals that an average Indian family spends 18.6 per cent of its annual income managing diabetes.

The cost data, drawn from a large study in north India, shows that for many middle- and lower-income households, diabetes has become an economic disease, consuming money that might otherwise go to education or savings. Experts say costs rise sharply once complications—like kidney or eye damage—set in, often pushing patients into debt or forcing them to abandon treatment.

Recognising this, the 2025 guidelines place emphasis on nutrition and prevention. They outline clear, affordable targets: at least 25-30 grams of fibre daily, four to five servings of vegetables, more millets and legumes, and a sharp cut in ultra-processed foods. Instead of demonising staples like rice or roti, the guidelines call for portion control and personalised meal planning to fit diverse Indian diets.



India already hosts over 100 million people with diabetes and another 136 million at the pre-diabetic stage, say ICMR–INDIAB estimates. The RSSDI warns that without dietary reform and early detection, the economic toll will far exceed the health-system's ability to cope.

The new guidelines mark a shift—from managing diabetes in clinics to confronting it as a national socio-economic challenge. Prevention begins not in hospitals but on the Indian plate.